



QUARTERLY EFFECTIVENESS READ · CFO SESSION

Spending With Proof, Not ROAS

A Q1 2026 read of the \$4.2M retail-media and \$11.6M trade-promo envelopes
— measured on modeled incrementality, not platform-reported return.

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Pacvue-orchestrated · Marian Holt elasticity model (refreshed Apr 15, 2026)

THE BOTTOM LINE

Executive summary

\$0.65

Incremental revenue per \$1 of retail media

\$2.73M

Incremental of the \$4.2M envelope

\$11.6M

Q1 trade-promo envelope

2.2×

ROI on the LA tactical injection

Read on platform-reported ROAS, Q1 retail media looks healthy. Read on **modeled incrementality** — the only number that survives a CFO's scrutiny — it is uneven. The blended envelope returns \$0.65 of incremental revenue per dollar spent. That number is dragged down by one platform: Amazon Ads, which reports a 1.08 ROAS but delivers only \$0.41 of true incremental revenue because it double-counts a subscribe-and-save base we would have sold anyway.

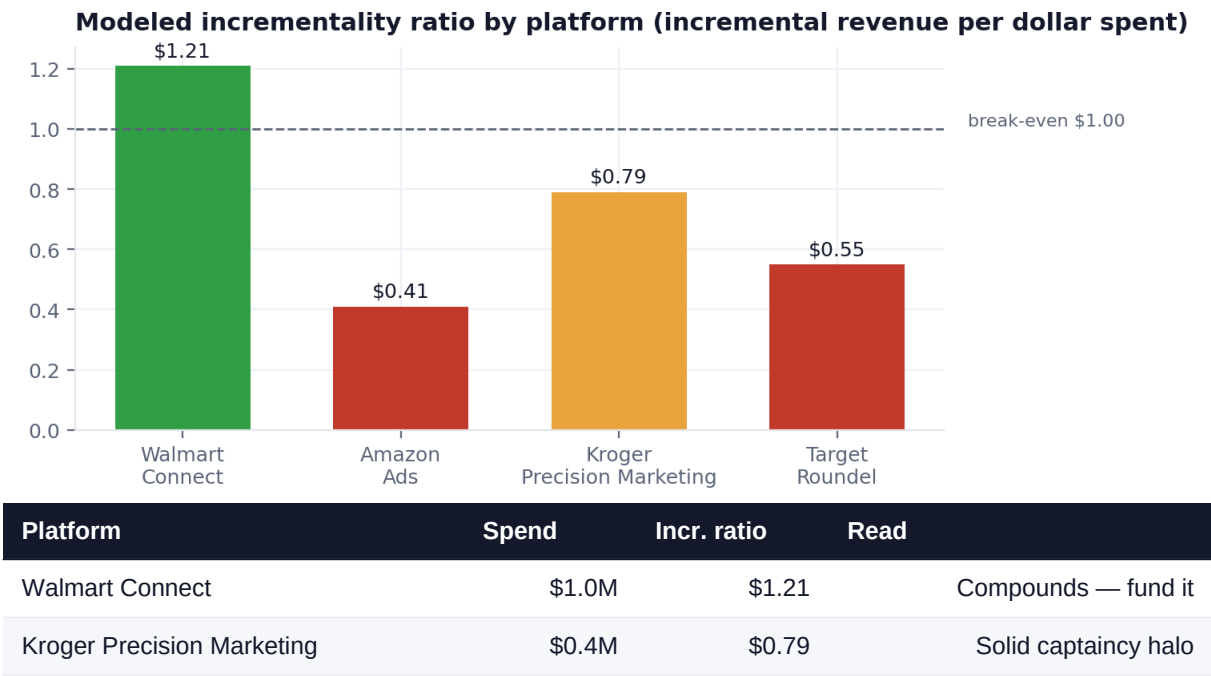
Where the money works, it works hard. Walmart Connect returns \$1.21 per dollar; the Louisiana tactical trade injection turned \$280K into \$612K of incremental revenue (2.2× ROI). The recommendation is to stop funding cannibalization and move it to the platforms that compound.

The single recommendation

Pull \$700K out of Amazon Ads in H2 and redeploy it to Walmart Connect and Kroger Precision Marketing. Same envelope, materially higher incremental return.

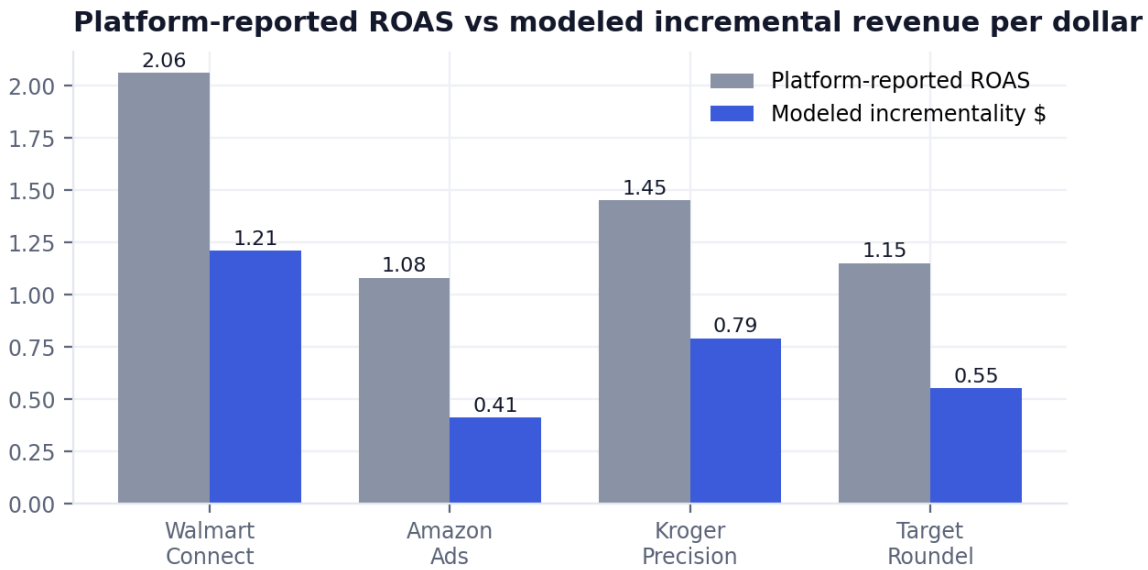
RETAIL MEDIA

Not all platforms are equal

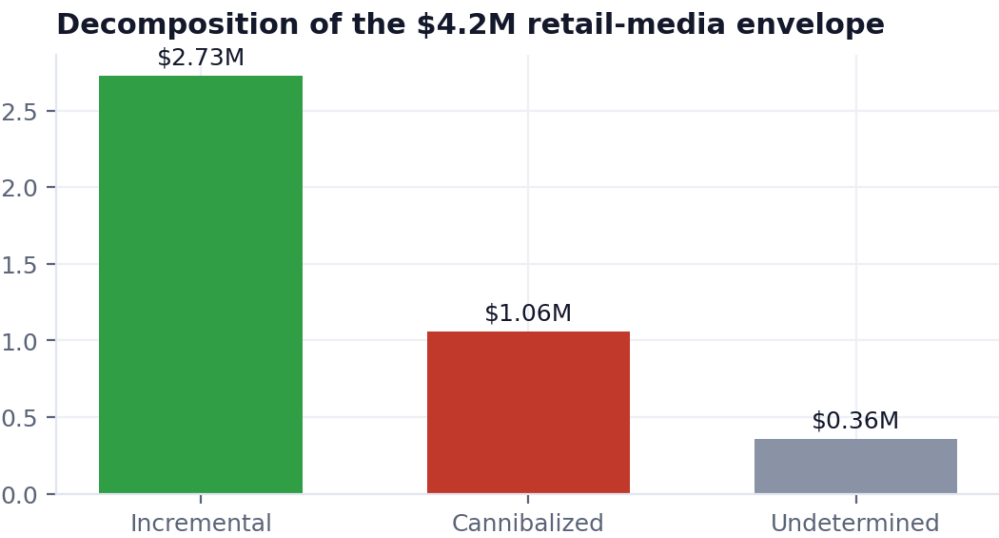


Platform	Spend	Incr. ratio	Read
Target Roundel	\$0.4M	\$0.55	Hero account; steady
Amazon Ads	\$2.4M	\$0.41	Cannibalization-heavy — cut

Why Amazon flatters itself



Amazon's reported ROAS counts every attributed sale, including the subscribe-and-save base that recurs regardless of advertising. Once that base is removed, \$0.59 of every reported dollar is cannibalization or undetermined. The decomposition below shows the same story at the envelope level: of \$4.2M spent, \$2.73M is genuinely incremental, \$1.06M is cannibalized base, and \$0.36M is undetermined within the confidence band.



TRADE PROMOTION

One injection that worked, one cluster that didn't

- **Louisiana tactical injection (TPE-Q1-011):** \$280K of trade spend drove 1.1 points of share recovery (vs a 1.2-point model expectation) and \$612K of incremental revenue — a 2.2× incremental ROI and the template for the August Walmart play.
- **Mountain West value-destroyer:** three Q1 events (TPE-Q1-018/019/020) posted negative modeled incrementality — promoting volume that would have sold at full price. Stop them.
- **ProteinPeak out-earns Crunchwell on the same dollar:** at the SKU level, ProteinPeak Berry Crunch returns ~2.3× what Crunchwell Original Mega returns on Amazon Ads at compatible bid CPCs — a portfolio-allocation signal for H2.

Trade-promo envelope discipline

The \$11.6M Q1 trade envelope is not the problem; its allocation is. The LA injection proves tactical, time-boxed depth with a hard end date pays back. The Mountain West cluster proves untargeted everyday depth destroys value.

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR H2

Four moves

- Reallocate \$700K from Amazon Ads to Walmart Connect + Kroger Precision Marketing.
- Kill the three Mountain West trade events; redeploy to the Louisiana recovery and the August Walmart facing push.
- Tilt H2 retail media toward ProteinPeak SKUs where incremental ROI is ~2.3× the Crunchwell equivalent.
- Govern all spend on modeled incrementality, not platform-reported ROAS; refresh Marian's elasticity model quarterly (last refreshed April 15, 2026).

Sources: *retail_media_spend_q1_2026* (24 rows, sums to \$4,200K), *trade_promo_events_q1_2026* (43 rows, \$11,598K), *sku_elasticity_estimates* (refreshed 2026-04-15), *data_freshness_log*. All figures from the Acme synthetic dataset.